



DVD Writers

First the floppy, then the CD and now, the DVD. Offering oodles more space, the DVD is set to rule the roost

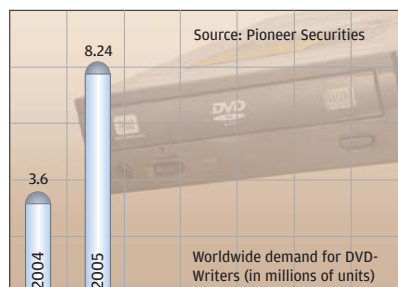
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The first DVD player was released in the US market in March 1997. Sony released their first commercial DVD player in April 1997. Since then, the number of DVD players sold in the US has risen to more than 85,00,000, while more than 1,22,00,000 DVDs have been sold.

The acceptability of DVD as the most preferred storage media on this side of the planet is slowly but surely picking up—with good reason. DVD-ROM drives are fast becoming regular devices in PCs, and computer users as well as DVD movie enthusiasts are aware of the fact that DVD writers not only allow you to back up data, but also copy movie DVDs.

Why DVD?

Say you need to take a large backup, and say your options are a new large hard disk, a DVD-Writer or a tape drive. Investing in a new hard drive may look feasible, but suffers from the portability angle. A tape drive can be very expensive for a SoHo business.



And this leaves only the DVD-Writer. Commonly available DVD media in the market today costs around Rs 120, while a DVD-Writer costs approximately Rs 5,000. The costs involved in purchasing a tape drive and cartridges may be too much for a SoHo business, leave alone a home.

This is why the DVD comes out tops. While offering more than six times the storage space of a CD, it is also very affordable now. Yes, it does take some time for writing data on to a DVD, but this is better than juggling seven CDs around one after the other.

The Format Wars

Buying a DVD writer is just a matter of minutes. However, buying the right one will need some research from your side. First up, let us clear the confusion among the various formats of DVD media available in the market.

The DVD-R/RW format was developed by Pioneer and released back in 1997. However, they faced various compatibility issues.

The DVD-R format is further split into DVD-R (A) (Authoring) and DVD-R (G) (General) formats. The difference is the laser used to write on them. DVD-R (A) and the DVD-R (G) are not compatible with each other: DVD-R (A) disks are not recordable in DVD-R (G) drives and vice-versa.

In addition, the capacities of these disks vary according to format. DVD-R (A) disks have